

JAILER IN NUMBERS

What Sun Pictures earned from the blockbuster

₹200-220 CRORE

A. SUN PICTURES INVESTMENT

₹310-320 CRORE

B. TOTAL PRE-SALE OF RIGHTS

₹60-70 CRORE

C. REVENUE OVERFLOW*

₹370-390 CRORE

D. TOTAL REVENUE (B+C)

₹150 CRORE

PROFIT (D-A)

*ADDITIONAL COLLECTIONS DISTRIBUTORS SHARE WITH PRODUCER WHEN A FILM OUTPERFORMS EXPECTATIONS

SOURCE INDUSTRY ESTIMATES

► *Jailer* raked in at least ₹150 crore in profit for producer Sun Pictures

► Industry insiders peg the total revenue it would have fetched at ₹370-390 crore

► It was made on an estimated budget of ₹200-220 crore

have to bring down audience expectations with a hit comedy film. Reserve the heroism for the next film. If you reduce it and amp it up, it will hit the target.” *Baashha* did and how, Krissna adds. If *Veera* got him more family audiences, *Baashha* and *Muthu*—the two action super hits released in 1995—cemented his superstar position. During *Jailer*’s success meet recently, the actor himself spoke of the predicament he faced in picking the right film after *Baashha*’s success—similar to what he faces today after *Jailer*. “*Jailer*’s success made me happy only for five days... after five days, my mind moved on to the next picture. Orey tension [Complete tension]; how to outperform or equal *Jailer*’s success and deliver another hit?” Rajinikanth’s office did not respond to *Business Today*’s requests for comment.

FOREIGN SHORES

If *Baashha* was an instant cult classic locally, *Muthu* opened up a market for the actor in Japan. One aspect of his bankability is the strong overseas business of his films. *Jailer*, for instance, collected ₹196 crore gross in overseas markets. His films do well wherever Tamilians live—whether that is domestically or internationally in the US, Malaysia, Singapore and even Russia, says Ramanathan. But Japan is a unique case where even native Japanese are fans. Three years after *Muthu* was released in India, a chance opportunity gave the film’s producer Kavithalayaa Productions the idea to release a subtitled version theatrically in Japan along with the now-defunct Japan Cinema Associates. One key strategy was to position Rajini as the Indian Jackie Chan—*Muthu* was an action comedy and Chan’s popularity as an action comic was spreading from Hong Kong to Japan and Hollywood. It worked. After originally releasing only in five to six screens, the makers had to increase the count due to higher demand. “You can put a movie on a thousand screens but you cannot make people like it,” says Bharathan. Recently,

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MIXED BAG



MOVIE **2.0 (2018)**
BUDGET (₹ CR) **500-600**
WORLDWIDE GROSS
COLLECTION (₹ CR) **723**



MOVIE **PETTA (2019)**
BUDGET (₹ CR) **160**
WORLDWIDE GROSS
COLLECTION (₹ CR) **232.92**



MOVIE **DARBAR (2020)**
BUDGET (₹ CR) **200-240**
WORLDWIDE GROSS
COLLECTION (₹ CR) **247**



MOVIE **ANNAATTHE (2021)**
BUDGET (₹ CR) **180**
WORLDWIDE GROSS
COLLECTION (₹ CR) **172**



MOVIE **JAILER (2023)**
BUDGET (₹ CR) **200-220**
WORLDWIDE GROSS
COLLECTION (₹ CR) **604**

SOURCE SACNILK & INDUSTRY ESTIMATES